Stage 3: Years later

Bone graft for a cleft in the gum: the three stages

This model shows the same jaw a few years after the graft. The eye tooth has come through the new bone. Braces line up the teeth.

PLACEHOLDER: picture of the Years later model

Whole jaw: eye tooth through, braces on

Render with tools/sheet/render.js once the model is built.

Whole jaw: eye tooth through, braces on

PLACEHOLDER: picture of the Years later model

Implant with a crown

Render with tools/sheet/render.js once the model is built.

Implant with a crown

PLACEHOLDER: picture of the Years later model

Bridge with one wing

Render with tools/sheet/render.js once the model is built.

Bridge with one wing

PLACEHOLDER: picture of the Years later model

Plate with a false tooth

Render with tools/sheet/render.js once the model is built.

Plate with a false tooth

What has changed

Bone now joins the two parts of the jaw where the gap was.[1]

The eye tooth came down through the graft. It is now fully in the row of teeth.[2,3]

Most eye teeth come through on their own. Some get stuck. Then a small operation uncovers the tooth, and the braces slowly pull it down.[3,4,5]

Fixed braces line up the teeth. Almost everyone who has this graft needs them.[1,6]

The missing tooth

There are two main plans for the gap left by the tooth that never grew.

Close the space. Braces move the eye tooth into the place of the missing tooth. Then the dentist reshapes it and adds tooth-coloured filling so it looks like the missing tooth. Teams use this plan most often for children with a cleft.[7,1,8,9]

Keep the space. While you are still growing, a plate you can take out holds a false tooth in the gap. When you stop growing, your dentist can fill the gap for good with:[10,11]

- an **implant**: a small post in the bone with a false tooth (a **crown**) on top
- a **bridge**: a false tooth with one wing glued to the back of the tooth next to the gap

The pictures show each choice.

Your cleft team will talk with you about which plan suits you.[10]

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